

1. **Academic Year:** 2026/27
2. **Course Code:** CCCH9029
3. **Course Title:** Ideas and Practices of Healing Arts in Traditional Chinese Medicine
4. **Course Description:**

This course introduces ideas and practices of healing arts in Traditional Chinese Medicine (TCM) through a critical exploration of ancient Chinese philosophy and history of TCM in its dynamic formation and development. The course seeks to enhance students' interests in ancient medical practice from modern science and enriches students' knowledge of key ideas and methods of healing arts in medical sciences, philosophy, religion, and literature.

The course also engages them in cross-cultural inquiry by contrasting or connecting TCM with science and modern medicine. In light of influential theories in TCM, such as “陰陽五行” (Yin-Yang and five elements), “天人相應” (correlation between man and nature), “原氣論” Qi (vital energy) and “藥食同源” (the same origin of herbs and food), a number of key concepts in TCM will be explained. Comparison of Chinese medicine with modern medicine will be involved and there will also be debates on controversial cases to stimulate student discussion. First-hand experience of TCM will be demonstrated with student participation and a cross-cultural discussion on the vital interactions between TCM and modern medicine will be held in the class.

[There are two compulsory visits and one of them (School of Chinese Medicine) will be scheduled during Reading Week.]

5. **Assessment Ratio:** 100% coursework
6. **Offer Semester:** First semester
Day of Teaching: Wednesday
7. **Offering Department(s):**
School of Chinese Medicine - 100%
8. **Course Co-ordinator:**
Professor Z.J. Zhang (Staff No: 56093)
School of Chinese Medicine, Li Ka Shing Faculty of Medicine
Tel: 3917 6445 Email: zhangzj@hku.hk
9. **Teacher(s):**
Professor Z.J. Zhang (Staff No: 56093)
School of Chinese Medicine, Li Ka Shing Faculty of Medicine
Tel: 3917 6445 Email: zhangzj@hku.hk
(Teaching Load: 58%)

Professor J.G. Shen (Staff No: 39898)
School of Chinese Medicine, Li Ka Shing Faculty of Medicine
Tel: 3917 6429 Email: shenjg@hku.hk
(Teaching Load: 42%)

10. **Study Load**

Activities	Number of hours
Lectures	24
Tutorials (i.e. small group face-to-face discussions)	8
Fieldwork / Visits	10
Reading / Self-study	50
Assessment: Presentation (incl preparation)	8
Assessment: Essay / Reflective writing	40
Total:	140

11. **Course Learning Outcomes and Alignment with Common Core Programme Learning Outcomes**

Course Learning Outcomes – On completing the course, students will be able to:		Alignment with Common Core Programme Learning Outcome(s)
1.	Explicate the philosophy and key concepts in traditional Chinese medicine (TCM).	CC PLO(s): 1, 2
2.	Analyze ideas of “the holism of man and nature” and “same origin of herbs and food” that influence TCM practice, Chinese cultural tradition, and the lifestyle from past to present.	CC PLO(s): 1, 2
3.	Compare different origins of Chinese and modern medicine and evaluate advantages and limitations of both.	CC PLO(s): 1, 2, 3
4.	Apply TCM knowledge learnt into daily life and critically consider the prevention and treatment of common diseases.	CC PLO(s): 1, 2, 3, 4

12. **Assessment Tasks**

Assessment Method	Details of Assignment <i>[Limit: 250 characters]</i>	Weighting	Alignment with Course Learning Outcome(s)
Tutorials	Participation, preparation & discussion assessments.	20	CLO(s): 1, 3
Presentation	20 minutes group presentation and 10 minutes Q & A.	20	CLO(s): 3, 4
Short essay	One short essay with at least 1500 words.	25	CLO(s): 1, 3, 4
Group project	Create a recipe of Chinese Medicinal cuisine and cook it, present by a short video.	25	CLO(s): 2, 4
Field trip	Participation in the field trips, submit a reflective writing and complete 10 MCQs via Moodle.	10	CLO(s): 2

13. **Course Content and Topics**

1. Traditional Chinese medicine (TCM): from Ancient Healing Art to Modern Sciences
2. The Correlation between Human Beings and Nature – Understanding the Causes of Diseases
3. Yin-Yang and Five elements & The Philosophic Theory of “Qi”
4. Zang-xiang (藏象)- Inferring the Internal Changes from External Observation
5. Meridians and Acupuncture: Metaphysical or Scientific?
6. Chinese Medicines: not only tasting, but also healing
7. Healthy Body and Happy Spirit: Implication from Traditional Chinese Healing Art
8. A Glance of Chinese Medicine Practice, Training, and Research – Visiting School of Chinese Medicine
9. Diet Regulation for Health Preservation and Rehabilitation: Unity of Chinese Philosophy and Therapeutic Idea
10. From “Trials and Errors” Experiences to Formation of Chinese Medical Therapeutic Theory
11. Drug discovery and Traditional Chinese Medicine
12. Common diseases: preventable, curable, and incurable

14. **Required Reading**

- Hu, J., & Liu, B. (2012). The basic theory, diagnostic, and therapeutic system of traditional Chinese medicine and the challenges they bring to statistics. *Statistics in Medicine*, 31(7), 602-605. From <https://doi-org.eproxy.lib.hku.hk/10.1002/sim.4409>
- Sun, D., Li, S., Liu, Y., Zhang, Y., Mei, R., & Yang, M. (2013). Differences in the origin of philosophy between Chinese medicine and western medicine: Exploration of the holistic advantages of Chinese medicine. *Chinese Journal of Integrative Medicine*, 19(9), 706-711. From <https://doi-org.eproxy.lib.hku.hk/10.1007/s11655-013-1435-5>
- Tai, S., & Sun, F. (2014). Diseases and Their Etiologies. In S. Xutian, S. Tai & C. Yuan (Eds.), *Handbook of Traditional Chinese Medicine* (pp.99-117). Singapore: World Scientific Publishing Co. From https://doi-org.eproxy.lib.hku.hk/10.1142/9789814293839_0007
- Zhang, Z., Wang, X., & McAlonan, G. (2012). Neural Acupuncture Unit: A New Concept for Interpreting Effects and Mechanisms of Acupuncture. *Evidence-Based Complementary and Alternative Medicine*, 2012, Article ID 429412. From <http://dx.doi.org.eproxy.lib.hku.hk/10.1155/2012/429412>

15. **Additional Course Information**

Compulsory field trips: School of Chinese Medicine (during Reading Week) and Hong Kong Museum of Medical Sciences (during tutorial).

16. **Course Level Grade Descriptors**